

Vertigo

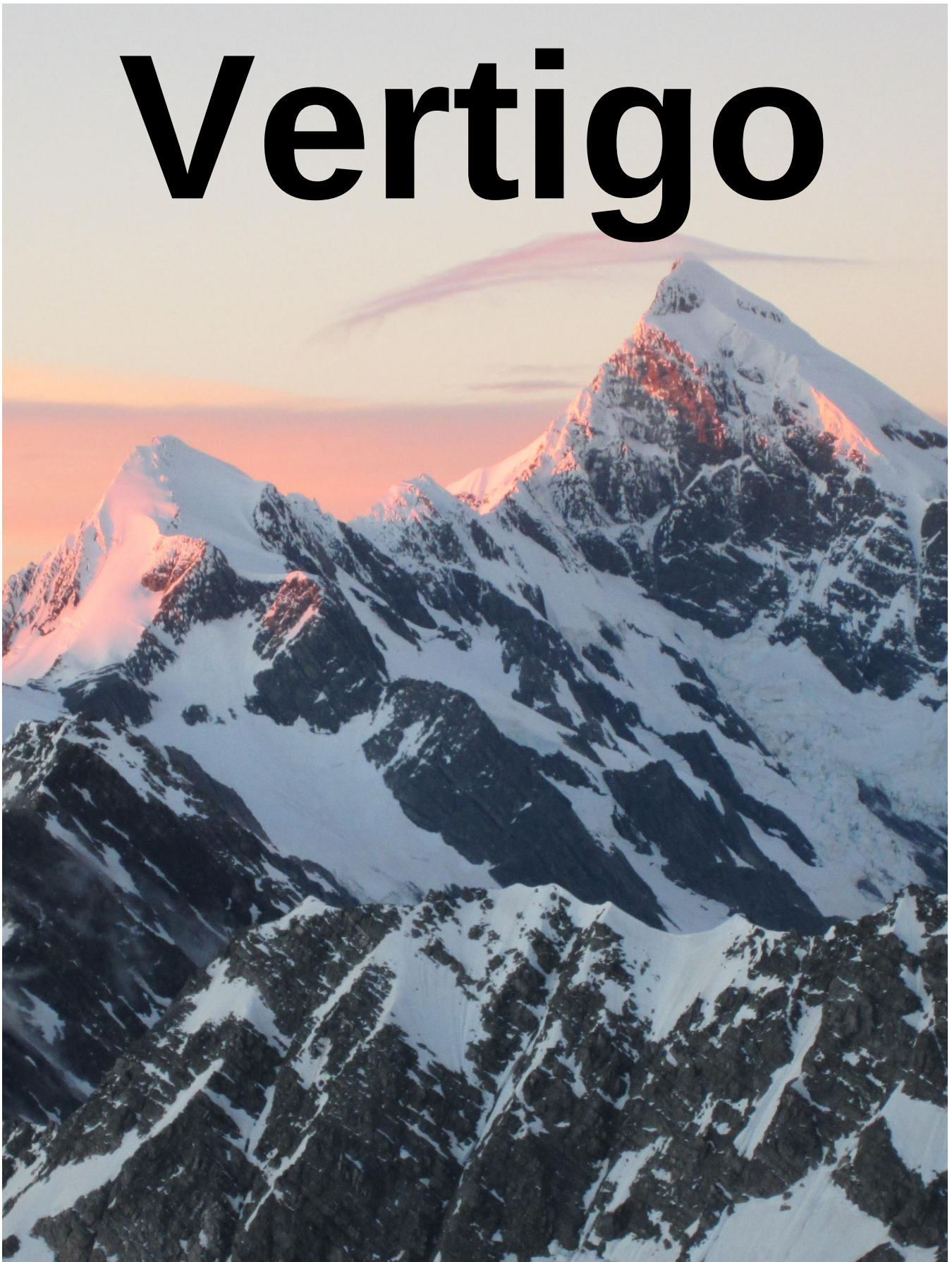


Photo Mt Sefton and the Footstool at sunrise (Photo: Simon Bell)

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section
www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Section News

July section night

Come along and here Jo Morgan talk at our July section night about some of her adventures. Here's a brief summary from Jo:

"Mountaineering is my "mid life crisis" activity so started at 58 years. I always liked climbing trees and doing age inappropriate things and found the Southern Alps and fell seriously in love.

So I'm trying to "knock off" all the peaks over 3000m. My last season 2013/14 included Aoraki/Cook, Dixon, Silberhorn, Ledenfeld, Tasman.

Then onto my motorbike, up Pakistan across the Taklamakan desert into Tibet and rode up to Everest Base Camp. A 56 degree temperature spread and sea level 5300m ride.

I'm having more fun than a granny should."

Section Nights are usually at the Tararua Tramping Club clubrooms, 4 Moncrieff Street, Mount Victoria, Wellington on the second Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings start 8.00 pm with tea & coffee afterwards

Upcoming Events

Learn to Ski-tour Course – August / September

This August and September, the Tararua Tramping Club is repeating last year's successful Learn to Ski-Tour Course and we would like to open this year's course to NZAC members. Full details of the course can be found on

<http://www.ttc.org.nz/pmwiki/pmwiki.php/TTC/SkiTouringInstruction>



Applicants must be intermediate level or better skiers who have completed a basic snow craft course and an Avalanche Awareness Course. For those who have not completed an Avalanche Awareness Course, the TTC organises a RAL operated course that applicants can attend prior to the start of ski-touring instruction. NZAC members do not need to join the TTC to do the course.

Remarkables Ice and Mixed festival 14 – 17 August 2014

SO WHATS THIS FESTIVAL ALL ABOUT?

- Bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world.
- Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ.
- Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing.

- Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi pitch winter training area The Remarkables.
- Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships.
- Fundraising for the NZAC expedition fund.

There are limited places available on the clinics and discounts available for NZAC members so be quick to secure your place. Full details on the festival can be found at

<http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#>

North Island Ice Climbing Meet 12-13 July

The meet is now in its third year. This a super popular event where the Auckland, Central North Island, and Wellington sections come together to share their love of climbing ice. Based at the awesome Tukino lodge on the wild side of Mt Ruapehu. Super quick and easy access to a huge amount of water ice. This is not a beginners trip, you should, at a minimum, have completed a snowcraft course or similar. For more information contact Ant Stead (newsletter@aucklandclimber.org.nz)

NZAC Wellington Snowcraft 2014 Course 15th-17th August

WHAT: Learn snow craft basics – balance and movement, ice axes and crampons and an introduction to mountain awareness.

HOW: One week-night gear and logistics session (30th July) and a weekend away at the Tukino Alpine Sports Club on the eastern flank of Mt Ruapehu (15th-17th August).

COST: \$230 (Includes: accommodation and food). Gear hire and Alpine Club membership are additional costs.

If you are not currently an NZAC member, then you will also be required to join to participate in this course.

The pre-course evening is on Wednesday 30 July 6.00-8.00pm – Bivouac, Mercer Street, Wellington.

If you would like to register for this course, please download the registration form by clicking [here](#).

If you have questions email us at: wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

You can email your completed registration form to the same address as well.



If the weather or conditions prevent the course running on 15th -17th August, an alternate date has been set aside on 29th – 31st August. If the course successfully runs on 15th – 17th August, the alternate weekend would be available for those participants who would like to attend a club trip where they can practise their new found skills.

Cost of NZAC Membership can be found by clicking [here](#)

Benefits of the NZAC membership include:

- A 1 year subscription to the quarterly publication of 'The Climber Magazine'
- A copy of the NZ Alpine Journal.
- Discounted rates on all NZAC huts as well as DOC huts.
- Discounts at selected outdoor retailers and partners.

For a full list of benefits, please visit the NZAC website <http://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

Trip Reports

East Ridge of Mt D'Archiac

Queen's Birthday 2014

Sean Buchanan, David Grainger, Geoffroy Lamarche, Paul Maxim

At the end of May / beginning of June, four Wellington Section members, Sean Buchanan, David Grainger, Geoffroy Lamarche and Paul Maxim tacked on another couple of days to the Queen's Birthday weekend - thanks Liz - and successfully climbed the East Ridge of Mt D'Archiac. The wind stayed away and the sun shone beautifully for all five days – but not on us as we only enjoyed its rays for just a few hours during the entire three days of actual climbing. It was water-ice cold and the under-crampon conditions were as varied as you would expect for this time of the year. Paul is going to tell us all about the trip at the October section meeting but, till then, here's a picture of what it was all about.

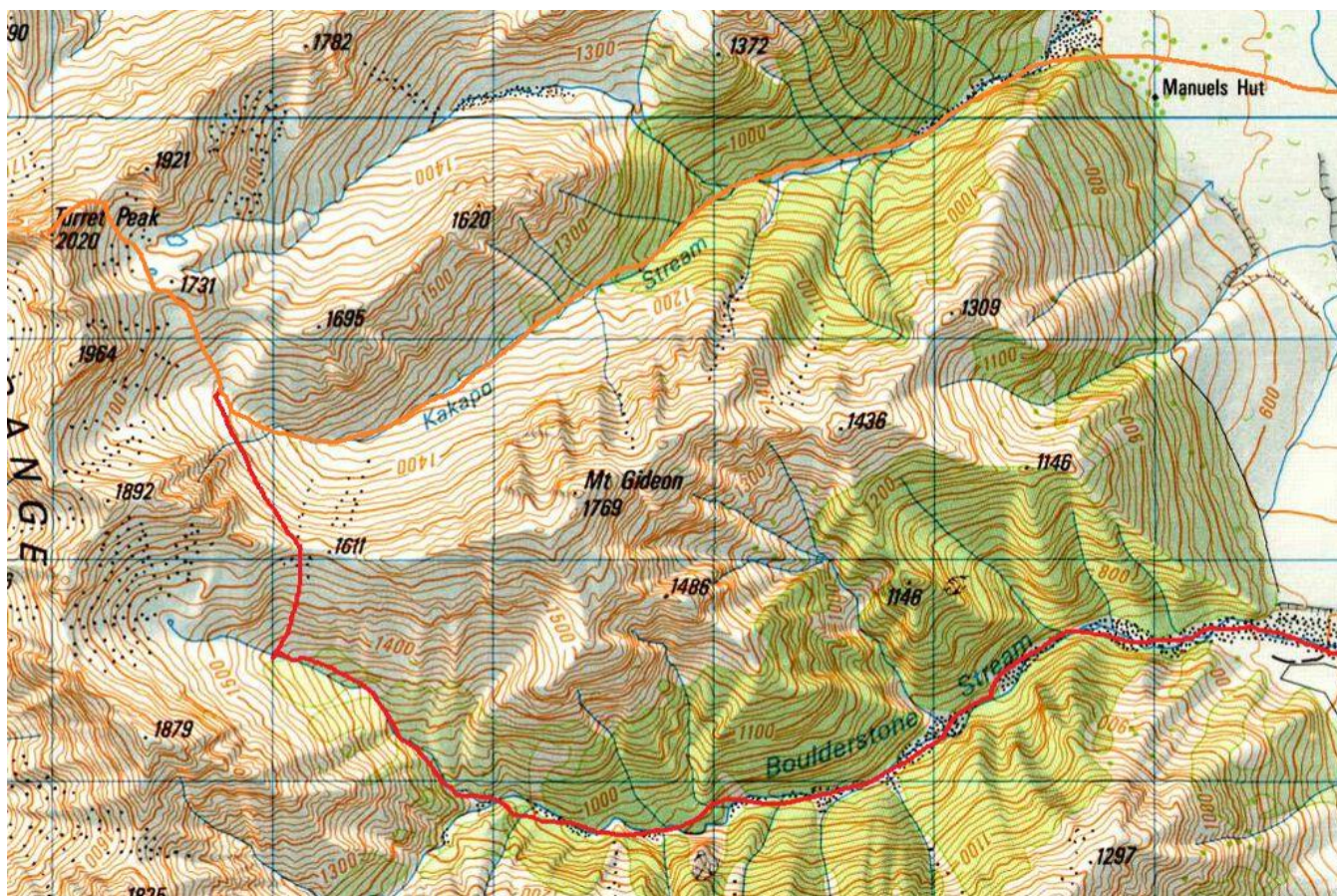


Picture taken from just short of the summit of Mt D'Archiac looking down the upper East Ridge (Paul Maxim)

Simon Bell, Nina, James and Robert

Some Christchurch friends (Nina and James) and I decided to attempt this peak via the NE ridge (grade 2-) as a social weekend trip sometime in May.

This trip was confirmed for 10/11 May a couple of days prior (once sighting the excellent weather forecast). What better way to get to know the last-minute (fourth) member of the team (Robert) than by spending Friday night on his couch? Over dinner we came up with a plan to make this a loop trip (up Bolderstone Stream and down Kakapo Stream) with a high camp at the tarns below Turret Peak.



Map (red is day one, orange is day two)

We didn't expect the route to be technical but decided to each bring a harness, a short rope and a few slings 'just in case'. I volunteered to bring my 30m 9.1mm joker, but on seeing the sight of it (a few nicks here and there) and the fact it was a bit damp (my car boot has started to leak!) an alternative rope was soon provided! Funny thing was, the rope we ended up taking was over twenty years old! It belonged to James' dad who possibly didn't climb much, based on the seemingly excellent condition of his rope! As it turned out we ended up taking this rope 'for a walk' so its condition wasn't put to the test.

Saturday

Early Saturday morning we drove to the head of Lake Coleridge, passing Darfield and Windwhistle on the way, and drove to the start of the Wilberforce Canal. True to the guidebook's comment we didn't see any other climbers at the road-end. We met some duck-shooters instead, and they advised us that crossing the Wilberforce further up the valley was possible at that moment (great news as the alternative is to take a detour to below where much of the Wilberforce is diverted into the canal on route to Lake Coleridge).

The river is quite braided but one of the braids was quite big. We finally managed to cross near the start of Boulderstone Stream (our attempts lower down were aborted). The main difficulty was the water wasn't flowing clear (snow melt?) so while it wasn't actually flowing that high or that deep it still looked intimidating. It was also very cold!

Heading up Boulderstone Stream was straightforward although we encountered a bit of verglas on some of the river rocks higher up the valley. We crossed onto the ridge north of Boulderstone near pt 1611 and sidled around pt 1892, before heading towards our intended campsite near pt 1731. We ended up camping 200m below this as it looked cold and snowy higher up!



Photo taken from col near pt 1611 looking towards Turret pk (left of obvious snowy col)

We arrived at our camp easily before dark and had all the modern luxuries – running water, comfy beds and dehy kangaroo meat for dinner!

Sunday

This was the trip where I finally accepted that it is no longer summer. I resolved that on the next trip I would pack a warm base layer instead of a glacier shirt! Nevertheless, we still got plenty of sleep and the alpine start wasn't too bad (up at 5:30am).

The actual climb was fairly relaxed. There was a small amount of snow around but it was not well consolidated, rendering our crampons useful only for pack-weight training. Possibly the climb is actually better with some snow on it, as some sections of the ridge were a bit chossy. Not too bad by NZ standards though! There were one or two sections where a rope could have been used, but care would have to be taken to ensure that it didn't dislodge rocks if abseiling.



Accessing the ridge proper on Turret peak



Looking towards the Wilberforce Valley from near the summit.

As they say reaching the summit is only half-way and in this case I definitely agree. That problem was not with the descent of Turret peak itself, it was with our descent of Kakapo Stream. The guide book does mention a 500m bush-bash and we found this quite slow going. I'd definitely recommend descending this instead of ascending it (or avoiding it all together!)

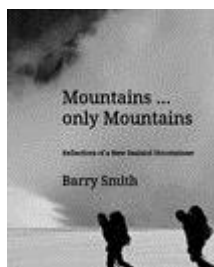
We arrived back at the car just on dark, and checked out the new (for Christchurch) Burger Fuel on the way home. I returned to Wellington on the red-eye flight Monday morning.

This was a fun sociable weekend trip. I recommend it if you want to check out a new area, don't want an epic challenge and don't like arriving back at work on Monday feeling totally shattered.

Notices

New book available – “Mountains ... Only Mountains”

In "Mountains ... only Mountains" Barry Smith comments on and describes his approach to the culture of mountain climbing. This book describes some of the ups and down of his climbing, his reflections on climbing, and celebrates his life-long love of the mountains and valleys of New Zealand.



He has included some of his poems and photographs from his times in the hills from the 1950s.

This book has been published by Blurb (see www.blurb.com), a US publishing company and is available as a hardcopy book or as an eBook. For the

hardcopy version of the book, click here <http://www.blurb.com/b/5401838-mountains-only-mountains> or, for the eBook click here <http://store.blurb.com/ebooks/478289-mountains-only-mountains>.

UIAA Mountaineering Commission - Legal Expert Working Group

The UIAA are seeking volunteers from the legal field for this group. This working party has been particularly efficient at the end of the nineties and the beginning on this century. The UIAA survey conducted a few years ago indicated that this work seems to be needed and appreciated by the federations. Unfortunately this group made up of volunteers has shrunk, many members have left due to their commitments to business or because of ageing. To achieve our goals and the new tasks the Management Committee entrusted us with, new members are definitely needed. The ideal person for the role would be a lawyer familiar with sports' law or liability or environment regulations at national or international level. If anyone can assist please contact John Cocks on President@alpineclub.org.nz. The NZ Alpine Club will process any nominations received and ensure the nominations are passed to the appropriate party at the UIAA Mountaineering Commission.

2014 NZ Alpine Club Photographic Competition

Entries are open for the 2014 NZAC Photographic Competition. Rules, information and a useful document written by Mark Watson providing tips for better climbing photos can be found at <https://alpineclub.org.nz/photocomp>.

Benefits for Alpine Club members

There are numerous benefits available to Alpine Club members. For details see <https://alpineclub.org.nz/benefits-of-membership>

Photograph information requested

This poor quality photograph is of my father, Travis Brown, and I believe was taken January 1942 when he was stationmaster at Arthurs Pass.



My mother always said the young woman in the photograph was Ruth Adams and the photo was taken on Mt. Rolleston. Ruth's sister has recently confirmed that the woman is almost certainly Ruth Adams but I have no information about the climber who took the photograph or any other members of the climbing party.

Despite this taking place a very long time ago, I hope that more information about this photograph and the climbing party may still be available. A bonus would be to obtain a much better copy of the photograph as this one is in poor condition.

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NZ International Film Festival

The New Zealand International Film Festival (NZIFF) is approaching its programme launch, for films screening during July, August and September. We think anyone with a love of **mountaineering** will be interested in one of the films in particular and we wanted you to be among the first to hear about it: ***The Epic of Everest*** will be screening in Auckland, Wellington, Dunedin and Christchurch.

The Epic of Everest

The official film of the ill-fated 1924 attempt at Everest has been spectacularly restored by the British Film Institute. It's the most majestic and spooked of age-of-conquest documentaries, reverberant with the intimations of nature's indifference that the filmmakers could scarcely ignore when reviewing their remarkable footage. A new musical soundtrack by Simon Fisher

Turner, utilising electronica alongside Nepalese instruments, underscores the haunting effect. "In June 1924 George Mallory and Andrew Irvine walked to their deaths, disappearing from the view of their fellow explorers on the north-east ridge of Mount Everest. That there was a film-maker, with a customised camera and a telephoto lens, on hand to record any of their final steps is impressive, even when viewed from the age of citizen photojournalism... Modern viewers may squirm at the contrast between Noel's reverent approach to the mountain and his condescension toward the Tibetan locals. But it's the chill grandeur of his images, and the mystical note in his rueful conclusion, that will linger in your mind." — Pamela Hutchison, *The Guardian*

"This is one of the greatest treasures of the BFI National Archive. It represents a key moment in the history of mountaineering and remains an enduring monument to Mallory and Irvine." — Robin Baker, BFI National Archive

Exact details of session dates and venues will be announced closer to the opening of NZIFF. As this film is yet to be publicly announced it is not yet listed on our website so for further information about the film, or to discuss reserving group bookings before tickets go on sale to the public, please contact Debbie Fish on 04 802 2576.

To keep up to date with NZIFF programme as it is announced, visit our website at www.nziff.co.nz.

Scott's Last Expedition – new website

A new website that chronicles and commemorates Robert Falcon Scott's 1910-1913 expedition is now available at <http://www.scottslastexpedition.org/expedition/>.

An online exhibition was created by the Antarctic Heritage Trust as a lasting record of the award-winning centenary exhibition, Scott's Last Expedition, that toured internationally, a collaboration between the Antarctic Heritage Trust (New Zealand), Natural History Museum, London, and Canterbury Museum (New Zealand).

Wellington Section 2012/13 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Email alias*	Contact
Chairperson	Dan Pringle	chairperson	027 768-2185
Vice Chair	Vincent Zintzen	vicechair	
Secretary	Julian Davidson	secretary or CM2	
Treasurer	Adam Newberry	treasurer	
National Rep	Dan Pringle		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Vacant	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Simon Williamson		
	John Yu		
	Sharran Came		
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	vacant	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	vacant		
Instruction - Rock	vacant		
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Carolyn Ellis		Kaz1963@gmail.com
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	John Yu	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Sam Newton	sam@alpineclub.org.nz



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